

Part 1: Pre-Test & Demographics (2 minutes)

The moderator introduces the session, states that we are testing the interface and not the user, and collects basic profile info.

1. Age: *27*

2. Background / Field of Study or Work: *Mechanical Engineer*

3. Tech Comfort Level:

☐ Low (Basic browsing)

☒ Medium (Regular student / staff web usage)

☐ High (Advanced user / Developer)

4. Do you regularly use any built-in accessibility features on your devices? (e.g., Dark Mode, Increased Contrast, Screen Zoom, Keyboard-only navigation)

Note responses:

Dark mode, otherwise nothing consciously. I use dark mode often because it is more pleasant.

Part 2: Task-Based Testing (10 minutes)

Observe the user's behavior closely. Do not guide them unless they are completely stuck for more than 1 minute.

Task 1: First Impressions & Visual Discovery (2 mins)

Instruction to user: "Please open the test page. Look around for a moment without clicking anything and describe what you see. What stands out to you?"

User Observations:

Passive background, the link stands out. Very prominently rotating square. Focus is very strongly on the triangle. Pleasant to look at because it is dark (Dark Mode is enabled via OS).

Task 2: Interaction Discovery & Reduced Motion (2 mins)

Instruction to user: "Imagine the spinning square on this page is distracting to you or making you feel uncomfortable. Try to find a way to stop it from spinning."

Moderator Check: * Do they hover/interact with the widget to expand it?

Success: [☒] Easily [] With Difficulty [] Failed

User Observations:

You have to go to "Site preferences". To make it stop rotating, you probably have to go to "Reduced motion" and set it to "on".

Task 3: Feature Exploration (2 mins)

Instruction to user: "Take a look at the settings panel again. What other options or features do you see available here? Briefly change one more setting of your choice to see what happens."

User Observations:

High contrast will probably increase the contrast.

*Color scheme likely changes to another color. *Tries out light theme* Light is a very extreme change. Dark is more pleasant.*

Color blindness changes the color a little bit.

Task 4: Accessibility / Keyboard Navigation (2 mins)

Instruction to user: "Now, please move your hands completely away from the mouse or trackpad. Using only your keyboard (such as the Tab, Spacebar, Enter, and Arrow keys), try to change the site layout to Dark Theme."

Moderator Check:

Success: ☒ Easily ☐ With Difficulty ☐ Failed

User Observations:

Arrow keys do nothing. The tab key does something. Has never had anything to do with keyboard navigation before. Opens settings, intuitively opens the dropdown with enter, and uses the arrow keys to change the color.

Task 5: Free Exploration (1 min)

Instruction to user: "Feel free to click around or interact with anything else on this page for a moment before we finish up."

User Observations:

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Part 3: Post-Test Questionnaire & Ratings (5 minutes)

Ask the participant to rate their experience and provide qualitative feedback.

1. Functionality & Clarity

"On a scale from 1 to 10 (1 = completely confusing, 10 = perfectly clear), how easy was it to figure out how to use the widget functionality?"

Score: 9 / 10

Follow-up: Was there anything unclear, confusing, or unexpected about how the panels opened or how the options worked? (e.g., *Did you realize you had to hover over the widget or click the summaries to see the options?*)

The user would have wanted to click on the title "changing styles" first. However, when you read it, it is relatively clear. The widget is well embedded and does not distract.

2. Placement, Visual Styling & Size

"On a scale from 1 to 10 (1 = looks terrible/terrible placement, 10 = looks great/perfect placement), how would you rate the widget from a visual and positioning perspective?"

Score: 9 / 10

Follow-up: What could be improved visually or positionally? (e.g., *Is the bottom-left corner a good spot? Is it too small, too large, or blocking other content? Should the icon change?*)

Visually, it is very appealing. The colors are well coordinated. Harmonious and pleasant. The user would prefer to place the button at the top.

3. Contents

"What setting options would you think are important to have for such a widget in general?"

An option to adjust brightness, possibly.

A mode to hide images (unnecessary and distracting content) that cause distractions.

Existing options are very good and usefull.

4. Everyday Context

Question: "If this widget was present across all the websites you use daily, would you find it helpful, or would you find it annoying/intrusive?"

If it were in the normal menu, I would think that is good; if it were always present and floating, it would be distracting. I would integrate it into the navigation. People who need it will then know that it exists and will know where to look. Everyone else will then not be disturbed.